

Pact / Contract Testing - Installation & Setup

A complete guide to prepare the environment, install, configure, validate and perform the first functional use of the tool.

Manual objective

This manual guides you through the complete installation and setup process, from preparing the environment to final validation. Follow the steps in order and use the checks throughout the guide to confirm that each configuration was completed correctly.

Official references

<https://docs.pact.io/>

What Contract Testing is

Contract Testing verifies whether the consumer and provider agree on the interface used in the integration. It does not replace functional or E2E testing; it reduces the risk of incompatibilities between services.

How Pact works

In a consumer-driven flow, the consumer describes the interactions it expects from the provider. These interactions generate a Pact contract, which is then verified against the provider.

Consumer and Provider

The Consumer makes the call; the Provider handles the call. A contract describes relevant requests and responses without requiring all systems to be available at the same time during consumer testing.

Pact Broker/PactFlow

In distributed teams, contracts can be published and versioned in a broker so that consumers and providers can verify compatibility across versions.

Where QA adds value

QA helps identify critical integrations, error scenarios, version compatibility and gaps that should not depend only on late E2E testing.

Attention point

Do not turn Pact into a complete copy of the production payload. Overly strict contracts increase coupling and may break because of changes that are irrelevant to the consumer.